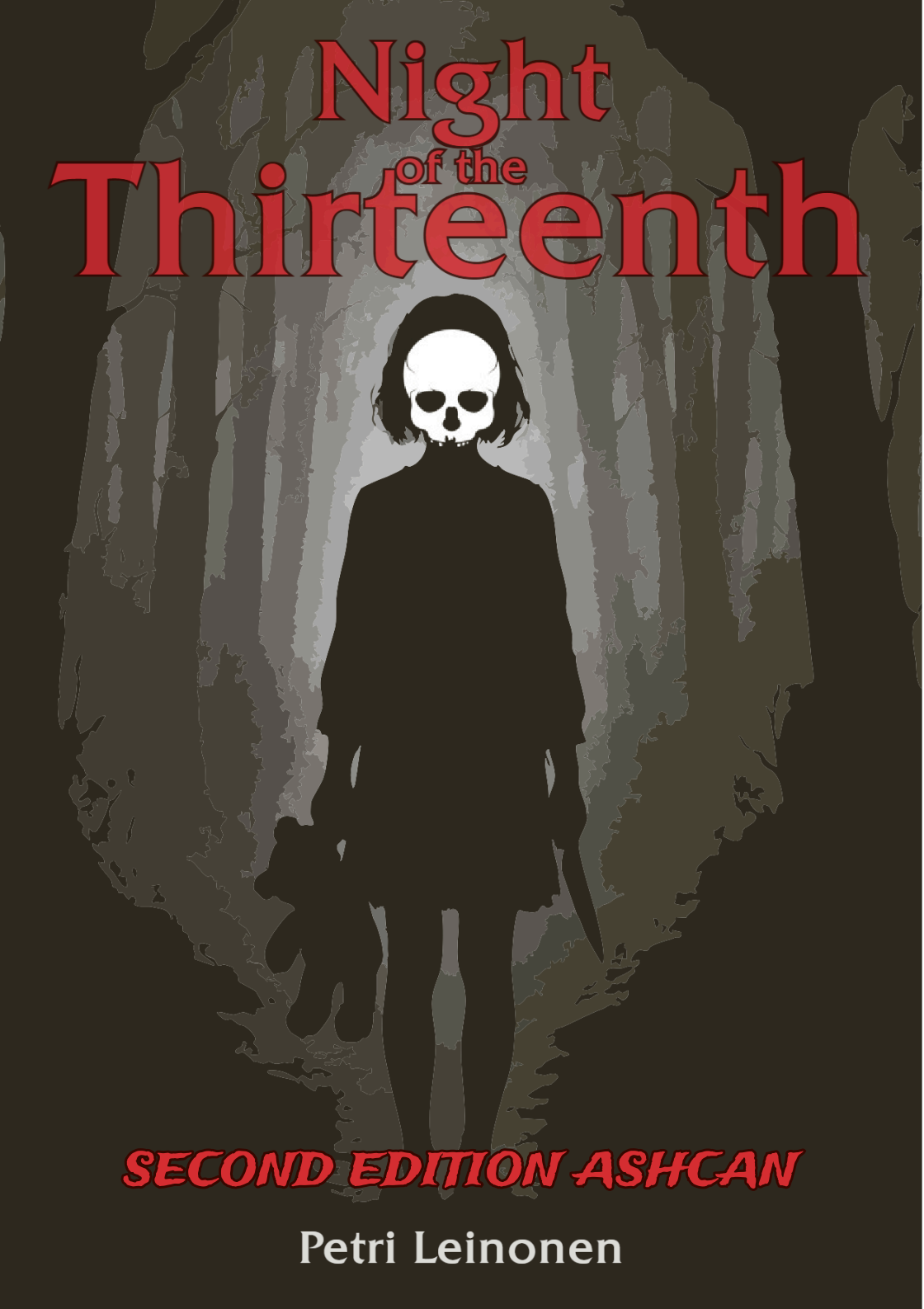
Night of the Thirteenth



SECOND EDITION ASHCAN

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Revised Interaction Core by The Table

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Uses the Vectorized Playing Cards 3.2 (https://totalnonsense.com/open-source-vector-playing-cards/)
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Rule of Thumb

Generally, more specific rules trump generic rules, and playset instructions supersede core rule instructions. If a card or playset says one thing and the core rules say another, follow the playset.

Optional Rules Modules (Playsets)

Playsets may enable special rule modules that modify setup or gameplay:

Classic Setup (*Generic Slasher*)

Uses the original curated deck escalation instead of random number piles:

- **Number Reserve**: Shuffle **5s**, **6s**, **7s**, **8s**, **9s**, and **10s** separately. Stack them face down so **5s** are on top and **10s** are on the bottom.
- **Threat Deck**: Shuffle all **2s**, **3s**, and **4s** together with **1 random Jack** face down. Place the **4 Aces** face up on top.
- **Trophy Pile**: Draw the bottom card of the Number Reserve (a random **10**) and place it face up to start the Trophy Pile.

Final Girl Rule (*Summer Camp Massacre*)

- **Lethal Encounters**: Any encounter with the Killer (whenever a **Face Card** is drawn onto the table) immediately results in **1 Strike** to assign.
- **Sole Survivor Climax**: **Act 3** and **The Finale** (adding the Jokers) begin immediately when there is **only one surviving character** left.

“No Director, Only Victims”

In this second edition of **Night of the Thirteenth**, we strip away the safety net. There is no permanent Game Master to guide you, save you, or condemn you. Instead, in each scene the **Active Player (AP)** steps into the spotlight as both the Protagonist and the **Director for the scene**—framing the start of the scene, maintaining the tone, and holding final authority (and veto power) over their character’s actions.

They are not alone. The rest of the table shifts roles to play side characters, the **Camera Crew**, and the **Editor**—answering sensory questions, escalating the danger, and ensuring the horror lands with maximum impact. You are all responsible for the nightmare.

Requirements

- **Standard playing card deck** with two distinct Jokers (Red and Black).
- **Dice**: At least one **d10** and one **d4**.
- **13 Tokens**: To represent the central pool of **Genre Points**.
- **Writing Materials**: To record your name, archetype, and demise.

Setting Up

1. **Choose the Playset**: Decide which horror movie you are living through tonight.
2. **Build the Decks**: Follow **The Table Setup** on page 4.
3. **Create the Cast**: Follow **Creating the Cast** (or create on the fly during the 4 Prologue Aces).
4. **Begin**: Good luck. You’ll need it.

The d13

The game uses a unique die roll called the **“d13”**—a combination of a **d10** and a **d4** rolled together and added for a total between **1 and 13**:

- The **d10 (Main Die)** represents your skill and luck. The **0** face is read as **zero** (not ten), producing a result from **0 to 9**.
- The **d4 (Effort Die)** represents how hard you push yourself, producing a result from **1 to 4**. It is added to the Main Die AND sets your tier on the **Effort Scale**.

***Important:** A modifier can never raise or lower a die outside its natural range (**0–9** for the d10, **1–4** for the d4). You cannot roll higher than 13 or lower than 1.*



The Table Setup

The Threat Deck: The horror starts small. Take the **Face Cards**, **Aces**, and **Jokers** aside. Shuffle the remaining Number Cards (**2–10**) and deal **8 random number cards** face down. Add **one random Jack** to this pile and shuffle it again. Place the **four Aces** face up on top as the Prologue.

During the Prologue, resolve the top Ace one by one. In the Main Game, **draw up to two cards** face up onto the table and choose one to face.

The Reserves: Deal **14 of the remaining number cards** face down to form the **Number Reserve** (remove any leftover number cards from the game unseen). Shuffle the remaining **Jacks (3)**, **Queens (4)**, and **Kings (4)** into three separate face-down **Face Card Reserves**. Keep the **two Jokers** face up and separate for the Finale.

The Trophy Pile: Flip the **top card** of the **Number Reserve** face up to start the **Trophy Pile** (leaving **13 cards** in the Number Reserve).

Whenever you succeed against a Number Card, place it face up on top of the **Trophy Pile**. Its top card sets the **Base Difficulty** whenever you confront a **Face Card** or **Joker**.

4 Aces on top for the Prologue; draw 2 cards in the Main Game.



13 Number Reserve cards & Face Card Reserves get added to the Threat Deck





And these when you get to the Endgame



13 Genre Points in a central pool for the table to award



Trophy Pile: top card sets Base Difficulty against Face Cards

How hard the next challenge is going to be.



What the challenge will be about

The Suit

... of the **Threat Card** tells you the nature of the challenge and which **Aptitude** applies:

- ♠ : **Power** — physical challenges & brute force
- ♥ : **Resolve** — challenges of nerves & fear
- ♣ : **Intellect** — know-how & investigation
- ♦ : **Finesse** — speed, stealth & precision

The Number

... of the **Threat Card** sets the **Target Difficulty** you must roll equal to or higher than on the **d13**:

- **Aces (Difficulty 1)**: Prologue Establishing Shots. Impossible to fail; keep the Ace as your Aptitude token.
- **Number Cards (2–10)**: Static Difficulty equal to the card's **Rank** (**2 to 10**).

The Threat Card

Face Cards (The Killer)

In the Main Game, up to **two Threat Cards** are face up on the table, and the Active Player chooses one to resolve.

Face Card Lock: While a **Face Card** is on the table, you **cannot draw** another card from the Threat Deck. You may resolve the other visible card first, leaving the Face Card as the sole remaining card the next Active Player **must** confront!

When confronting a **Face Card**, you face the Killer directly. The Suit still sets the nature of the scene, and the **Difficulty** is determined by adding the **Trophy Pile's** top card to the Face Card's modifier below:

Face Card, so you're going to face the Killer for your next challenge!



Jack +1 / Queen +2 / King +3

Running a Scene

Play proceeds in scenes around the table. In each scene, one player takes the spotlight as the **Active Player (AP)** and acts as the **Director for the scene**.

Phase 1: Scene Setup (Choose Your Path)

- **The Prologue (The Four Aces)**: The first four scenes resolve the four Aces on top of the Threat Deck. Each Ace showcases the character with the matching **Aptitude** in an *Establishing Shot* (Difficulty 1). Because they use their Aptitude (**-1 Effort**), the worst Effort they can suffer is **Overexertion (3)**—never a Strike.
- **The Main Game**: Once all four Aces are resolved, ensure there are **two cards** face up on the table (unless locked by a **Face Card**) and choose **one** to tackle. Look up or improvise the threat from the card's **Suit** and **Rank**.

Phase 2: Conversation & Stakes (Focusing the Lens)

The Active Player has complete authority over their character's actions and a **veto right** over suggestions from other players (except step 3 below). Follow these four steps before rolling the dice:

1. **Set the Scene**: Based on the Threat Card, the **Active Player** describes where the scene takes place with their character front and center. The **other players** describe the surroundings and any side characters present.
2. **Focus the Camera**: The Active Player asks an Act-specific sensory question, and the other players answer to build atmosphere:

   - **Act 1**: *"What does it look/smell like?" "How close is the Killer?" "How dark is it?"*
   - **Act 2**: *"What sound makes you freeze?" "Where is the blood coming from?" "Who is watching you?"*
   - **Act 3**: *"Why is there no hope?" "What part of your body hurts the most?" "How do you know you're going to die?"*

3. **Escalate ("Something's Not Right...")**: Once per scene, any other player may interject: **"Something's not right..."** and introduce a terrifying detail that makes the situation worse. The Active Player **must accept this truth** (no veto).
4. **Commit to the Effort (The Stakes)**: Before rolling, the table asks the Active Player: *"If you end up pushing yourself to reach your goal, what are you willing to risk?"* Agree together on a specific **Overexertion** sacrifice fitting the current Act. **You may not roll until the sacrifice is agreed upon.**

Phase 3: The Test

When the stakes are set, roll the **d13** (**d10 Main Die** + **d4 Effort Die**), apply any **Genre Point** reroll or **Aptitude** adjustment, and compare your **Total** to the card's **Difficulty**:

- **Equal or Greater (Total ≥ Difficulty)**: **Success.** You achieve your goal and push through the challenge.
- **Less (Total < Difficulty)**: **Failure.** You fall short and the situation spirals out of control.

The Effort Scale (Pushing Your Luck)

Regardless of whether you succeeded or failed, the final result of your **d4 Effort Die** determines the physical and narrative toll of the attempt:

1 — Controlled Effort (Safe & Effective): You kept your cool. You narrate the outcome (Success or Failure) **entirely on your own terms**. You look capable, or your failure is tragic and noble.

2 — Pushing It (Minor Costs): You exerted yourself. You narrate the core outcome, and the other players suggest **2–3 minor costs** (scratches, noise, lost time). You choose **one** cost to include in the scene.



3 — Overexertion (Guaranteed Sacrifice): You pushed too hard. Whether you Succeeded or Failed, the **Agreed Sacrifice** from Phase 2 happens:
• *If Success*: You achieve your goal, but you pay the price.
• *If Failure*: You don't get what you wanted, and you *still* pay the price.

4 — Breaking Point (Disaster Strikes): You lost control. The **Agreed Sacrifice** happens, **AND** it gets worse. The other players suggest **"The Twist"**—a new, horrible revelation or immediate danger. You choose which Twist becomes true, and you immediately take **1 Strike**!

Phase 4: Fallout & Deck Updates

After narrating the close of the scene, check if any player wishes to award a **Genre Point** from the central pool, record any **Strikes** earned, and update the decks based on the card resolved:

1. Aces (The Prologue)

Remove the resolved Ace from the game and place it in front of the Active Player as their **Aptitude** token. Do **not** place it on the Trophy Pile or draw from the Number Reserve.

2. Number Cards (2–10)

- **On a Success**: Place the resolved Number Card face up on **top of the Trophy Pile** (updating the Base Difficulty for future Face Cards). Then take the top card of the **Number Reserve** and place it face down at the **bottom of the Threat Deck**.
- **On a Failure**: Place the resolved Number Card face down at the **bottom of the Threat Deck** to haunt you again later, AND place the top card of the **Number Reserve** face down at the **bottom of the Threat Deck**.

3. Face Cards (Facing the Killer)

- **On a Success**:
  1. **Check Suit Weakness**: If this is the **first time** you have defeated a Face Card of this Suit (♠ ♥ ♣ ♦), you uncover one of the Killer's **Weaknesses**—remove this Face Card from the game permanently! If you already found this Suit's Weakness earlier, the Face Card stays in the Threat Deck.
  2. **The Killer Retaliates**: Based on your final **Effort Die (d4)**:
     - **Effort 1–2 (Controlled / Pushing It)**: Add a random **Jack** from the Reserves to the Threat Deck.
     - **Effort 3–4 (Overexertion / Breaking Point)**: Add a random **Queen** from the Reserves to the Threat Deck.
  3. **Shuffle**: Shuffle the **entire Threat Deck** (including any unchosen card on the table) and shuffle the **Trophy Pile** to reveal a new random top Trophy Card.
- **On a Failure**: The Active Player takes **1 Strike** (in addition to any Strike from rolling Effort 4). Add a random **King** from the Reserves to the Threat Deck, return all table cards to the Threat Deck, and shuffle both the **Threat Deck** and the **Trophy Pile**.

Empty Face Card Reserves: If a Reserve pile is empty when adding a card, substitute the next closest rank: **No Jacks?** Add a Queen (then King). **No Queens?** Add a King (then Jack). **No Kings?** Add a Queen (then Jack). If no Face Cards remain in any Reserve, add nothing.

The Three Acts

A session of **Night of the Thirteenth** unfolds across three escalating Acts, shifting the pace from creeping atmospheric dread to a relentless fight for survival.

Act 1: The Setup

The Killer is a shadow in the background—watching, waiting, and isolating the cast before the massacre begins in earnest.

- **Duration**: From the first Prologue Ace until the **very first confrontation with a Face Card is resolved** (whether you Succeed or Fail).
- **Pacing**: Only the single **Jack** seeded into the initial Threat Deck can appear during Act 1. As soon as that Jack is faced and resolved, **Act 2 begins immediately**.

Act 2: The Horror Story

The blood has been spilled. The Killer is now actively hunting the group, and every scene pushes the survivors closer to the edge.

- **Duration**: Continues until **all four Suit Weaknesses are uncovered** OR **all 13 cards from the Number Reserve have been added** to the Threat Deck.
- **Uncovering Weaknesses**: Each time you defeat a **Face Card** of a Suit (♠, ♥, ♣, ♦) for the first time, record that Suit's Weakness and remove that Face Card from the game.

Act 3: The Climax

There is nowhere left to hide. The quiet moments are over—every scene is now a direct confrontation with the Killer.

- **Trigger**: Begins immediately when **4 Weaknesses are found** OR when the **13th Number Reserve card** is added to the Threat Deck (or when **1 survivor remains** under the *Final Girl Rule*).
- **Purging the Deck**: Immediately **remove all Number Cards** from the Threat Deck (and set aside any remaining Number Reserve). Only **Face Cards** remain in the Threat Deck!
- **Entering the Finale**: Once all **four Suit Weaknesses** have been found, shuffle both **Jokers** into the Threat Deck (see **The Endgame** on page 13).

Creating the Cast

You are no heroes. You are just in the wrong place at the wrong time.

Choose a **Name**.

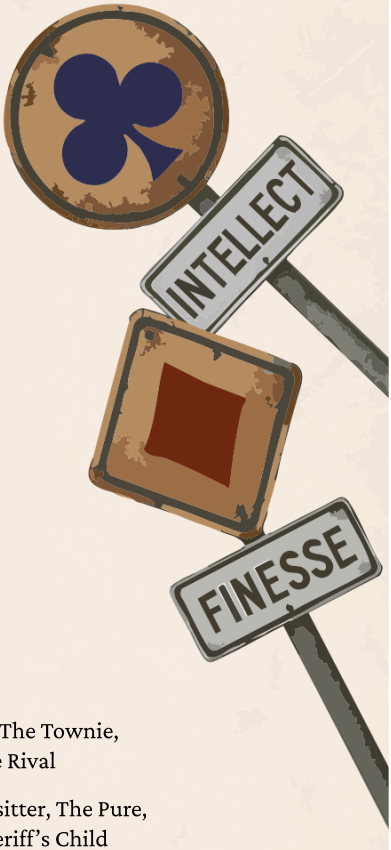
Come up with a clear **Archetype**.

Answer **"Why are you here?"**.

Claim a distinct **Aptitude** (**Power**, **Resolve**, **Intellect**, or **Finesse**). Matching a living character's Aptitude lets you shift your **Effort Die (d4)** by **±1**.

On-the-Fly Creation: *Or create characters during the first four scenes as the Prologue Aces assign each Aptitude!*





Archetype examples

Ideas for ♠ (**Power**): The Jock, The Protective, The Townie, The Greaser, The Sheriff, The Father, The Rival

Ideas for ♥ (**Resolve**): The Final Them, The Babysitter, The Pure, The Sibling, The Atoner, The New Kid, The Sheriff's Child

Ideas for ♣ (**Intellect**): The Genre Savant, The Reporter, The Skeptic, The Loner, The Bookworm, The Techie, The Conspiracy Nut

Ideas for ♦ (**Finesse**): The Rebel, The Class Clown, The Royal Bee, The Thief, The Rich Kid, The Cheerleader, The Slacker

For your consideration: It makes a balanced cast when each of the four players claims a different **Aptitude**—ensuring every Suit is covered at the start of the night, until characters begin to die!

Using your character to influence rolls

Genre Points

Lean on the tropes

The Table begins with **13 Genre Points** in a central pool. At the end of any scene, **any player** can award a Genre Point from the pool to the Active Player (or another player) for leaning into a horror trope (*"I'll be right back!"*), making a dramatic roleplay choice, or genuinely terrifying the table.

Spending a Genre Point: During Phase 3 (The Test), you can spend one held Genre Point to **reroll both dice (your entire d13)** and add **+1 to the d10 Main Die** (max 9). **Warning:** You must accept the new result, even if it is worse! The spent token is **removed from the game** permanently.

Aptitude

Play to your strengths

Whenever a Threat Card's Suit matches the **Aptitude** of a **living character** at the table, the Active Player may adjust their **Effort Die (d4)** result by **±1** after rolling (within the **1–4** range):

- **Increase Effort (+1)**: Push yourself harder to raise your **d13 Total by +1** (turning a near-miss into a Success), at the cost of escalating your **Effort Scale** tier.
- **Decrease Effort (-1)**: Rely on natural talent to lower your **Effort Scale** tier by 1 (avoiding a Breaking Point Strike or Overexertion), while lowering your **d13 Total by -1**.
- **Death & Jokers**: When a character dies (3 Strikes), their Suit's Aptitude is **lost for the rest of the game**. No one gets an Aptitude edge against a **Joker**!



Three Strikes and you're out!

Every character in **Night of the Thirteenth** gets two close calls with death before the end comes for them.

You gain a Strike when you:

- **Fail any Test against a Face Card (the Killer).**
- **Roll a 4 (Breaking Point) on the Effort Scale** (whether you Succeed or Fail the Test).
- *(Optional Final Girl Rule)*: Whenever a **Face Card** is drawn onto the table.

A **Strike** means something horrible either happens to your character or *almost* happens to them—leaving them bloodied, cornered, or traumatized. *(Note: Failing against a Face Card while also rolling a 4 on the Effort Scale inflicts **two Strikes** at once!)*

The Third Strike: When your character receives their third **Strike**, their story is over. In a genre-fitting, gruesome fashion, they meet their demise. Collaborate with the table to stage their final scene. Once dead, that character's **Suit Aptitude** is permanently lost for the rest of the game. If all four characters are killed, the Killer wins!

The Endgame

Should you survive long enough to defeat a **Face Card** from all **four Suits** (♠♥♣♦)—uncovering all four of the Killer's **Weaknesses**—the night reaches its bloody crescendo.

Remove **all Number Cards** from the **Threat Deck**, leaving only the remaining **Face Cards**. Both **Jokers** are shuffled into the Threat Deck.

Whenever a **Joker** is drawn and confronted during the Endgame, its **Target Difficulty** is equal to the **Trophy Pile's top card (+0)**, and **no character may use an Aptitude modifier** on the roll!



The Black Joker (The Twist): *One last desperate attempt. What do you sacrifice to survive?*

Test against the **Trophy Pile's** top card:

- **On a Success**: Remove the **Black Joker** from the game, AND permanently remove the **highest-ranking Face Card** currently in the Threat Deck (**King → Queen → Jack**). Shuffle the Threat Deck and Trophy Pile.
- **On a Failure**: Remove the **Black Joker** from the game, and add a random **King** from the Reserves to the Threat Deck. Shuffle the Threat Deck and Trophy Pile.

The Red Joker (The Final Test): *The Killer has you dead to rights. How do you escape death?*

This is it—the true climax of the movie. Test against the **Trophy Pile's** top card:

- **On a Success**: **Victory!** You deliver the final blow or make the impossible escape. The Killer is defeated, and all surviving characters see the dawn!
- **On a Failure**: **Instant Death.** Your character is killed on the spot. If other survivors remain, shuffle the **Red Joker** back into the Threat Deck (and shuffle the Trophy Pile)—the nightmare continues!



Quick Reference

1. The 4-Phase Scene Loop

Phase	Summary of Actions
Phase 1: Setup	**Prologue:** Resolve the top Ace (Diff 1). **Main Game:** Ensure 2 Threat Cards are face up (unless locked by a Face Card) and choose 1 to resolve.
Phase 2: Stakes	1. **AP** sets the scene. 2. **AP** asks an Act sensory question. 3. Any player may interject *"Something's not right..."* (no veto). 4. Agree on the **Overexertion Sacrifice**.
Phase 3: The Test	Roll **d13** (**d10** `0–9` + **d4** `1–4`). Optional: spend a **Genre Point** (reroll both, +1 to d10, discard token) or apply living **Aptitude** (±1 to d4). Total ≥ Diff = **Success**.
Phase 4: Fallout	Narrate outcome via the **Effort Scale (1–4)**, award Genre Points, assign **Strikes**, and update the Threat Deck & Trophy Pile.

2. Target Difficulty

Card Type	Difficulty Formula
Ace (Prologue)	**1** (Auto-success)
Number (2–10)	**Card Rank** (2–10)
Jack / Queen / King	**Trophy Top + 1 / + 2 / + 3**
Red / Black Joker	**Trophy Top + 0** (No Aptitude)

3. The Effort Scale (d4)

d4	Narrative Toll
1	**Controlled:** AP narrates freely.
2	**Pushing It:** Pick 1 minor cost from crew.
3	**Overexertion:** Agreed Sacrifice happens.
4	**Breaking Point:** Sacrifice + Twist + **1 Strike**.

4. Deck Updates & Escalation

Card Type	On Success (Total ≥ Diff)	On Failure (Total < Diff)
Number (2–10)	Card → **top of Trophy Pile**. Top Number Reserve → bottom of Threat Deck.	Card → **bottom of Threat Deck**. Top Number Reserve → bottom of Threat Deck.
Face Card (J/Q/K)	1st time Suit defeated = **Weakness** (remove card). Add **Jack** (d4=1–2) or **Queen** (d4=3–4). Shuffle Threat & Trophy decks.	Take **1 Strike**. Add **King** from Reserve. Return cards and shuffle Threat & Trophy decks.
Black Joker	Remove Black Joker + remove highest Face Card in Threat Deck. Shuffle both decks.	Remove Black Joker + add **King** from Reserve. Shuffle both decks.
Red Joker	**VICTORY!** Surviving cast wins the game.	**Instant Death.** Shuffle Red Joker back in.

Act Transitions: **Act 2** begins after the 1st Face Card is resolved. **Act 3** begins when **4 Suit Weaknesses** are found OR **13 Number Reserve cards** are added (remove all Number Cards from Threat Deck). **The Finale** adds both Jokers once all **4 Weaknesses** are found.